

financial world has become complicated and you must learn to navigate it, for the most part, on your own. You are exposed to lines of credit, must make complex decisions regarding your 401(k)/retirement plans, must choose between different types of insurance, must be able to handle your checking account without having NSF (not sufficient funds) fees, and must be able to pay your bills on time to avoid negative marks on your credit reports.

Despite the fact that you may feel ill prepared, you can successfully make the move out of the nest. Once you are out, you should follow the lessons in this chapter to make sure you do not boomerang back:

- Create a moving out budget.
- Conduct research to find out anticipated expenses.
- Always pay needs before wants.
- Do not live a lifestyle you cannot afford.
- Be willing to decrease your standard of living.
- Take precautions to be ready for life events.

